

INITIAL

1. Passage anchor

> “...and had my **initials** engraved on it, which made it feel personal straight away.”

Passage meaning

initials = the first letters of a person's given name(s) and surname

姓名首字母；名字縮寫

For example:

> **John Michael Smith**

> → **J.M.S.**

In the passage, the speaker's initials were engraved on the fountain pen, making the gift feel personalized.

Practice

1. Her **initials** were engraved on the pen.

她的**姓名首字母**刻在鋼筆上。

2. Please write your **initials** in the corner.

請在角落寫上你的**姓名縮寫**。

Core meanings of INITIAL

2. initial — first letter of a name

As a noun:

= the first letter of a person's name

姓名的首字母

Examples

1. His first **initial** is J.

他名字的第一個**首字母**是 J。

2. Write your surname **initial** here.

在這裡寫下你姓氏的**首字母**。

3. initials — name abbreviation

= first letters of a person's names used together

****姓名首字母；姓名縮寫****

This is the exact passage sense.

Examples

1. The bag had her ****initials**** on it.

袋子上有她的****姓名首字母****。

2. He signed the page with his ****initials****.

他用自己的****姓名縮寫****在頁面上簽署。

Adjective: first / earliest

4. initial — first

= happening at the beginning

****最初的；起初的；第一階段的****

Examples

1. My ****initial reaction**** was surprise.

我****最初的反應****是驚訝。

2. The ****initial meeting**** went well.

****第一次會面****進行得很順利。

This is the other major everyday sense.

5. initial stage

= earliest stage of a process

****初期；初始階段****

Examples

1. The project is still in its ****initial stage****.

這個專案仍處於**初始階段**。

2. Problems appeared during the **initial stages**.

問題在**初期階段**出現。

6. initial response / reaction

= first response before further thought or development

初步反應；第一反應

Examples

1. Her **initial response** was positive.

她的**初步反應**是正面的。

2. My **initial reaction** changed after I heard the full story.

聽完整件事後，我的**第一反應**改變了。

7. initial impression

= first impression formed when encountering someone or something

初步印象；第一印象

Examples

1. My **initial impression** was wrong.

我的**第一印象**是錯的。

2. The design made a strong **initial impression**.

這個設計留下了很強烈的**初步印象**。

Verb: mark with initials

8. initial — verb

= write one's initials on a document or item

簽上姓名首字母；用縮寫簽名

Examples

1. Please **initial** each page.

請在每一頁**簽上姓名首字母**。

2. She **initialled** the change in the contract.

她在合約修改處**簽上了姓名縮寫**。

9. initial a document

= mark or approve a document using initials rather than a full signature

以姓名首字母簽署文件

Examples

1. Both parties must **initial** the amendment.

雙方都必須在修改處**簽上姓名首字母**。

2. He **initialled** every page of the agreement.

他在協議每一頁都**簽上了姓名縮寫**。

Initial as abbreviation more broadly

10. initial — first letter of a word

= first letter of a word, not only a personal name

單字首字母

Examples

1. The **initial** of “London” is L.

“London”的**首字母**是 L。

2. Each word begins with a different **initial**.

每個詞都以不同的**首字母**開頭。

Less common than “first letter,” but valid.

Linguistics

11. initial — word/syllable beginning

In linguistics:

= sound or segment occurring at the beginning of a word or syllable

****詞首音；聲母；起始音****

Examples

1. The word has a voiced ****initial**** consonant.

這個詞以一個濁音****起始輔音****開頭。

2. In some linguistic systems, the syllable ****initial**** is analyzed separately from the final.

在某些語言分析系統中，音節的****聲母****會與韻母分開分析。

Specialist but established.

Typography / manuscripts

12. initial — decorated opening letter

= large or decorative first letter at the beginning of a chapter, paragraph, or manuscript section

****裝飾首字母；首字大寫字母****

Examples

1. The manuscript begins with a decorated ****initial****.

手稿以一個裝飾性的****首字母****開始。

2. The chapter opens with a large illuminated ****initial****.

章節以一個大型彩飾****首字母****開頭。

More historical/typographic.

Related forms

13. initially

= at first; at the beginning

****起初；最初****

Examples

1. I was ****initially**** unsure about the idea.

我**起初**對這個想法沒有把握。

2. The plan was **initially** rejected.

這個計畫**最初**被拒絕了。

Very important high-frequency family member.

14. initialization / initialisation

= process of preparing or setting something to an initial state, especially in computing

初始化；初始設定

Examples

1. The system performs **initialization** at startup.

系統啟動時會進行**初始化**。

2. The device failed during **initialisation**.

裝置在**初始化**期間發生故障。

Technical computing use.

15. initialize / initialise

= set up or prepare a system, variable, device, etc. for first use

初始化；設定初始值

Examples

1. The program **initializes** the variable to zero.

程式把變數**初始化為零**。

2. The device must be **initialized** before use.

裝置使用前必須先**初始化**。

16. initialism

= abbreviation formed from initial letters pronounced separately

首字母縮寫詞

Examples

1. “BBC” is an **initialism**.

“BBC” 是一個**首字母縮寫詞**。

2. An **initialism** is usually pronounced letter by letter.

首字母縮寫詞通常逐字母讀出。

Useful distinction from acronym.

Key contrasts

17. initial vs first

first

= broad everyday word meaning earliest or number one

第一的；最先的

initial

= first at the beginning of a process, period, reaction, or sequence

最初的；初步的

Compare:

> my **first** job

> 我的第一份工作

> my **initial** reaction

> 我的第一反應 / 最初反應

Initial often sounds more formal.

18. initial vs original

initial

= at the beginning

最初的

original

= first version before changes, or not copied

原始的；原來的；原創的

Compare:

> initial plan

> 初步計畫

> original plan

> 原來的計畫

The original plan may still be discussed long after the beginning.

19. initial vs preliminary

****preliminary****

= coming before the main or final stage, often for preparation

****初步的；預備性的****

****initial****

= simply at the beginning

Compare:

> initial discussion

> 最初的討論

> preliminary investigation

> 初步調查

They overlap, but ****preliminary**** often suggests preparation for something more complete.

20. initial vs abbreviation

****initial****

= one first letter

****initials****

= several first letters, usually of names

****abbreviation****

= any shortened form of a word or phrase

****縮寫****

Example:

> J.K. = initials

> approx. = abbreviation

21. initials vs acronym

****initials****

= first letters representing names or words

****首字母****

****acronym****

= abbreviation formed from initial letters and pronounced as a word

****首字母縮略詞****

Example:

> NASA = acronym

while:

> FBI = more specifically an initialism

Meaning map

The central concept of ****initial**** is:

****something at the beginning****

From this develop:

Name

initial

→ ****姓名首字母****

Name abbreviation

initials

→ ****姓名縮寫****

Time/process

initial stage

→ **初始階段**

Response

initial reaction

→ **第一反應**

Verb

initial a document

→ **簽上姓名首字母**

Linguistics

initial sound

→ **詞首音 / 聲母**

Typography

decorated initial

→ **裝飾首字母**

Computing

initialize

→ **初始化**

The passage uses the personal-name branch:

> **my initials engraved on it**

> → **上面刻有我的姓名首字母**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
initial — name letter	一個人姓名中某個名字的第一個字母；姓名首字母
initials	一個人各部分姓名的首字母組合；姓名縮寫
initial — adjective	發生在最開始階段的；最初的 / 初步的
initial stage	一個過程剛開始的階段；初始階段
initial reaction/response	在深入思考前出現的第一反應 / 初步回應
initial impression	第一次接觸時形成的初步印象

initial — verb	在文件等上簽寫自己的姓名首字母	
initial a document/page	以姓名縮寫在文件 / 頁面上確認或簽署	
initial — first letter of a word	一個單字最前面的字母	
initial — linguistics	位於單字或音節開頭的音；詞首音 / 聲母	
initial — typography	章節或段落開頭的大型 / 裝飾首字母	
initially	在最開始時；起初 / 最初	
initialize / initialise	把系統、變數等設定到初始狀態；初始化	
initialization / initialisation	設定初始狀態的過程；初始化	
initialism	由首字母組成並逐字母讀出的縮寫詞	

Passage recap

> “...had my ****initials** engraved on it...”

Here:

****initials**** = ****the first letters of the speaker’s name****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****姓名首字母****

* ****姓名縮寫****

Natural contextual translation:

****上面還刻了我的姓名首字母。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****initials****

= ****the first letters of a person’s names used together as a shortened form of the name****

****姓名首字母；姓名縮寫****

The highest-value contrast is:

> ****initials****

> → J.K. / A.B.C. 一類姓名首字母

versus:

> ****initial reaction****

> → 最初反應

versus:

> **initial a document**

> → 在文件上簽姓名首字母

In the passage, the engraved **initials** make the fountain pen feel personally made for the speaker.